

Kcirna Revision (to Modern Kcirna)

Phonology

Recommendations

- Adjust coda-stop to fricative allophony in order to preserve words like *kcira* when they have a prefix
 - Currently *kcirna* [kʃir.na] but *mo-kcirna* [mox.ʃir.na], i.e. beginning [kʃ] is lost
 - Option 1: Only apply allophony to /t/ but not /k/ or /p/ (**my preference**)

Stop		Liquid		Fricative	
ktal	mok.tal	kroʃ	mok.roʃ	kʃir.na	mok.ʃir.na
pta.na	mop.ta.na	pnar	mop.nar	pso	mop.so
tku.na	moθ.ku.na	trup	moθ.rup		

- Option 2: Only apply allophony if second letter is not a fricative

Stop		Liquid		Fricative	
ktal	mox.tal	kroʃ	mox.roʃ	kʃir.na	mok.ʃir.na
pta.na	moh.ta.na	pnar	moh.nar	pso	mop.so
tku.na	moθ.ku.na	truh	moθ.ruh		

- Option 3: get rid of this allophony completely

Stop		Liquid		Fricative	
ktal	mok.tal	kroʃ	mok.roʃ	kʃir.na	mok.ʃir.na
pta.na	mop.ta.na	pnar	mop.nar	pso	mop.so
tku.na	mot.ku.na	trup	mot.rup		

Ideas

- Change u, o, and v to a similar non-labial sound (but keep m and p as closed-mouth rather than “labial” sounds)
 - u → ʊ
 - o → ʌ
 - v → ɦ → h or v → ʉ

Consonants

CLASSIC	Labial	Alveolar	Palatal	Velar	Uvular	Glottal
Nasals	m	n				
Plosives	p	t		k		
Fricatives		s	ʃ		χ	h
Liquid	ʋ	r l	j			

Modern	"Labial"	Alveolar	Palatal	Dorsal	Glottal
Nasals	m	n			
Plosives	p	t		k	
Fricatives		s	ʃ	χ	h
Liquid		r l	j	ɰ	

Vowels

CLASSIC	Front	Center	Back
High	i		u
Mid	e		o
Low		a	

Modern	Front	Center	Back
High	i		ɯ <y>
Mid	e		ʌ <u>
Low		a	

Nouns

Recommendations

1. Reduce all the positional cases (aside from Allative and Ablative) into a single Locative case
2. Remove paucal number

Ideas

1. Make certain cases specific to animate vs inanimate nouns
2. Remove collective number

Cases

CLASSIC CASE		Modern Case	
Absolutive	∅ (no affix)	Absolutive	∅ (no affix)
Ergative	m(o)-	Ergative	m(o)-
Instrumental	v(a)-	Instrumental	h(a)-
Genitive	-ku	Genitive	-ku
Benefactive	-(o)r	Benefactive	-(o)r
Allative	-re	Allative	-re
Ablative	-nan	Ablative	-nan
Superessive	-run	Locative	-lat
Subessive	-xuc		
Inessive	-(i)n		
Apudessive	-xe		
Pertingent	-lat		

Animate		Inanimate		Common Meaning
Ergative	m(o)-	v(a)-	Instrumental	<i>means of verb occurring</i>
Absolutive	∅	Absolutive		<i>affected by verb</i>
Genitive	-ku	Genitive		<i>related to head noun</i>
Comitative	-lat	Locative		<i>near to, in vicinity of</i>
Dative	-re	Allative		<i>destination, oriented to</i>
Causal	-nan	Ablative		<i>origin, oriented from</i>
Benefactive	-(o)r			<i>for the benefit of</i>

kciru-lat xtaj-xam=ti "I am flying with a dragon."

trup-lat kciru-ku xtaj-xam=ti "I am flying where a dragon is." (lit. I am flying at a dragon's location)

xtaj-vi-lat ana-min=ti "I sing while flying."

[xtaj-xam-lat] ta-ana "I sang while (I was) flying."

ka-re [xtaj-xam-lat] ta-ana "I sang to you while flying."

[trup-re ka-ku xtaj-xam-lat] ta-ana "I sang while flying to you."

Number

- single: -∅
- dual: -ho
- plural: -a

Pronouns

Person	base form	mo- form
1SG	ti	tom
1DU	tiri	tirim
1PL	hika	hinka
2SG	ka	kom
2DU	curi	muri
2PL	cua	mua

Demonstrative	Proximal	Distal	Unseen
Above	at	am	vaj
Equal	klet	klem	
Below	sut	sum	

Verbs

Keep

1. Copular clitics
2. Participles
3. Serial verb constructions

Recommendations

1. Remove Causative, Applicative, and Mediopassive
2. Remove Optative
3. Clarify/simplify relative clauses and subordinate clauses

Ideas

1. Move Subjunctive and Irrealis to separate marking

Copula

Person	PRES	PST	IRR
1SG	=ti	=(i)sti	=arti
2SG	=ka	=(i)cka	=arka
3SG	=(i)t	=(i)c	=ar
1DU	=les	=(u)lles	=lares
2DU	=lok	=(u)llok	=larok
3DU	=lam	=kas	=karas
1PL	=ton	=(u)nton	=taron
2PL	=takot	=(u)nkot	=tarkot
3PL	=tos	=nas	=taros

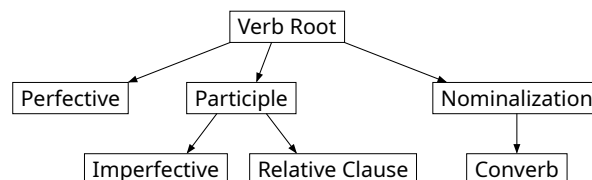
Perfective Prefixes

Person	Agent SG	Agent DU	Agent PL
1	ta-	tur-	xen-
2	ki-	mrur-	mren-
3	ci-	ckur-	spen-
1>2	tme-	toren-	tomni-

Person	Agent SG	Agent DU	Agent PL	Object SG	Object DU	Object PL
1	ta-	tur-	xen-	tom-	hur-	hin-
2	ki-	mrur-	mren-	kci-	kcur-	kcen-
1>2	tme-	toren-	tomni-			

Verb Template

-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4
Perfective	Directional	Root	Causative / Applicative	Medio- passive	TAM	Copula
	Body Part				Participle	
Case	Abstract Nominal- ization				Nominal- ization	Case



−1	0	1	2
Perfective	Root	TAM	
Case		Participle	Copula
		Nominalization	Case

- Perfective
 - Preterite
 - Future
 - Subjunctive →
 - Imperative (lacks agreement prefix)
 - Optative
- Copula
 - Present
 - Past
 - Irrealis →

- Participle
 - Stative
 - Progressive
 - Habitual
 - Potential
 - Antipassive
- Nominalization
 - Abstract/General
 - Locative
 - Temporal
 - *oan-vi-re xtaɟ* “Fly until you die”
 - Agent
 - Deverbal (one instance of the verb occurring)
- Converbs
 - Benefactive
 - Ablative/Allative
 - Instrumental
 - Locative
 - Consecutive
 - Despite
 - Conditional
 - Infinitive

Syntax

luh cinenku tom mruɣam “The man I saw went home”

luh cinenku mossan ti mruɣam “The man who saw me went home”